Product Specification - Saffron

1. Product Information

Item	Description
Product Name	Iranian Saffron
Scope	This specification applies to Safrron of varieties conforming to the characteristics of Vitas vinifera L. which have been suitably treated or processed and which are offered for consumption as saffron.
Product Code	**SUFL7211** o Saffron in cut filament (Negin, Sargol) o Saffron in filament (Pushal, Dasteh) o Saffron in powder form
Saffron in cut filament:	Dried stigmas of the Crocus Sativus L. flower (with styles removed completely detached from each other)*. The purest type of saffron is known as Negin and Sargol in Iran, however in Spain it is known as Coupe. **Negin** This kind of Saffron is pure and contains stigma without style like common red Saffron. But the remarkable features of this kind is longer and thicker threads (with less broken) than the common Saffron and also the Coloring power that is very high.This type of Saffron considered as one of the top quality Saffron in the world. **Sargol (RED Saffron – All Red Filaments)** This filament type, usually consists of only red parts of stigma (no style & pollen) with a high power of coloring and aroma and flavor. Sargol saffron stigmas range from 3/8” to 1/2” in length. In many other countries it is referred to as coupe saffron, cut or all red stigma.
Saffron in filament:	Dried stigmas with a part of the style of the Crocus Sativus L. flower. This type of saffron is known Pushal in Iran and Mancha in Spain. Using this same type of saffron, but sold in another manner, is Bunched saffron. Just like the name suggests, the saffron filaments are bunched together and tied with tread. This type is called Dasteh in Iran. **Pushal (Mancha)** This kind of saffron include red stigmas with 2 - 5 mm yellow style thread. The color strength is about 180, 200 USP or even more."Pushal" means massive for its volume resulted from the time and method of harvesting. "Pushal" has the samepower of coloring and aroma as "All red filaments" type and it usually use for fantasyand luxury packings. **Dasteh (Bunched)** This kind usually contains the whole natural threads of Saffron (red and yellow parts) which is bunched and tied with a string. The Coloring strength of Dasteh is usually about 140-160 USP and classified in to ISO category II or III.The red part along with the style and placed on each other and tied by a string.
Saffron in powder form:	**Saffron Powder** Particles obtained by crushing the filaments of the Crocus Sativus L. flower using sophisticated machines. The machinery crushes the stigmas in an enclosed and in frigid temperatures, as to not lose quality or quantity.
BRC Grade AA	Metal detected, Selection on belt

2. Organoleptic Properties

Item	Description
Appearance	Composed of saffron with the general appearance of the representative type
Style	Saffron in cut filament, Saffron in filament, Saffron in powder form
Colour	Natural, Uniform red to Dark red
Smell	Typical saffron aroma without any foreign smell or off- odour
Consistency	Firm, not sticky, free-flowing

3. Allergens

No Allergens: As described in EU Regulation no: 89/2003.

4. Physical Properties

Physical Parameters	Limit
Moisture	up to 10-12%
Foreign Bodies (related to the plant)	0.1%
Foreign Bodies (related to environment)	Negative
Khame with cap	0.5%
Picrocrocin	70- 85%
Safranal	20-50%
Crocin	200-220%
Color additives	Nil

5. Chemical Properties

Criteria	Maximum Quantity
Total ash	5.5%
Acid-insoluble ash	0.5%
Extract solution in water	65%
Arcenic	3ppm
Mercury	2ppm
Lead	10ppm
Sum of Heavy Metal	40ppm

All Chemical items are according to ISIRI 259-1

6. Microbiological Properties

Microbiological Properties	Limit
Clostridium	102 cfu/g
Mould	1,000 cfu/g
Enterococcus	Negative
E. Coli	Negative

All Microbiological items are according to ISIRI 5689

7. GMO/Irradiated Information

- We confirm that this product SUFL7211 has not been produced from GMO or does not contain any genetically modified organisms.

8. Shelf Life and Storage Conditions

- Recommended storage conditions are cool, ambient, dry, away from strong odour;
- Under specified storage conditions, the Shelf life 18 months from production date;
- Keep away from direct sunlight.

- The assessment to extend the shelf life of product beyond the best before end date declared on the label is at our clients' own shelf life protocol/testing and sole discretion.

9. **Packaging Details**
   - The product will be packed in food grade materials with the overall packaging having sufficient strength and stability.

Item	Bulk	Consumer Pack
Saffron	Upon customer request	1gr/2gr/4gr/10gr

10. **Metal Detection**

Parameters	Minimum detection size (Sphere size)
Ferrous	2.5mm
Non-Ferrous	Cu: 3.5mm, Al: 2.5mm
Stainless Steel	3mm

11. **Labelling**

Information printed on the carton:
- Net Weight
- Country of Origin (Optional)
- Exporter Profile (Producer)
- Product storage Information, Product code.

Information printed on the label:
- Lot No
- Best Before Date
- Importer Profile (Distributor) Upon Costumer requirement
- Purchase Order No. upon Costumer requirement

12. **Product Warranty Statement**
   - Certificate of conformance to the original specification is available upon request prior to delivery of the product. The product has long shelf life and is traded throughout the year. The product is prone to moisture, infestation, reabsorption, colour, texture and taste change based on the storage and packaging conditions. The suitability of the poduct for intended use must be checked by the buyer prior to use. Sarhara UK Foods Ltd cannot be held liable for consequences of specific use of the product neither it accepts any responsibility for the usage of the product beyond stated shelf life.

Agreement of Specification – If no signed copy of this specification is received within 28 days of issue to the Customer then this will be considered accepted.			
Supplier Name	Sahara UK Foods Ltd	**Customer Name**	
Name	Naveed Ul-Hassnan	**Name**	
Signature (on behalf of SUFL)	Naveed Ul-Hassnan	**Signature (on behalf of Customer)**	
Position	Quality Manager	**Position**	
Date	21/09/2021	**Date**	